

Chapter 53-3

Walking through the first floor corridor and opening the door at the very edge, there was a staircase leading to the basement.

Qi Jiao descended the stairs step by step. Before even entering the basement, she could already feel the sinister cold.

She raised her pale, thin hand and gently pushed open the heavy door.

Inside and outside the door were two different worlds.

Inside the door was pitch black. Even when the lights were turned on, there was only weak illumination.

Not even as bright as the momentary glow when a phone screen lit up.

The basement was dark and damp, even carrying a musty smell.

Various types of whips hung on the walls.

In the middle of the room, there was a rectangular contraption made of pebbles.

Qi Jiao walked in first, with Yang Jiani following closely behind. After she entered, she closed the door.

As if draining away all of Qi Jiao's hope.

Yang Jiani took the most handy whip from the wall, then said in a low voice, "Qi Jiao, kneel down."

Qi Jiao knelt on the area covered with pebbles, her knees pressed until they felt like they would shatter.

"Do you know your mistake?" Yang Jiani stood not far behind her, but in the darkness it was impossible to discern her position. Her voice was also very cold, merging with the basement. "How dare you?"

Qi Jiao bit her lip. "I'm sorry."

"Where did she touch you?" Yang Jiani asked.

Qi Jiao remained silent.

"Not going to say?" Yang Jiani asked again.

Qi Jiao only had that one phrase left: "I'm sorry."

Yang Jiani laughed coldly. "You really do like her. If my Jiao Jiao were still here, would she be dating now too?"

Qi Jiao pressed her lips together. "I'm sorry."

"My Jiao Jiao never said 'I'm sorry.'" Yang Jiani's voice became increasingly eerie, accompanied by low laughter. "My Jiao Jiao liked to say: 'Mommy, I was wrong.'"

Qi Jiao frowned, saying in a low voice, "Mommy, I was wrong."

"Wrong tone." Yang Jiani said, and with that, a whip struck Qi Jiao's back with fierce wind.

"..."

Qi Jiao closed her eyes, feeling the seemingly endless pain.

These days filled with agony—

When would they end?

Could one only find release by doing what she¹ did?

But then someone else would have to bear this suffering, wouldn't they?

Would these days ever end?

Footnotes:

1. **She:** This likely refers to another person who found "release" from similar suffering, possibly through death or escape, though the exact reference is ambiguous in this context.